

An illustration of the god Odin, depicted with a long white beard and a blue wide-brimmed hat. He is wearing a blue robe and is shown in profile, looking down into a well. He holds a dark, curved drinking horn in his right hand. The background is a light blue sky with stylized white clouds and a large, textured tree trunk on the left. The bottom of the image features a blue and white geometric pattern.

Mimir had drunk from the well many times, and his brain overflowed with knowledge.

“I am Odin,” the god declared, “and I wish to drink from your well.”

“I don’t care who you are,” Mimir replied. “No one sups here unless they make a suitable sacrifice.”

“What sacrifice do you require?” demanded Odin.

“Give me one of your eyes and I will allow you one drink.”

*So Odin plucked out one eye and dropped it into the water, where it floated just beneath the surface.*

Ignoring his pain, Odin looked down at his eye, and it looked back at him. Mimir was now satisfied. He filled his drinking horn with water and gave it to Odin.

As Odin drank, his mind exploded with insight. He knew the answers to a thousand mysteries, and he saw deep into the future. From then on he was called the “one-eyed god”, and he deemed his sacrifice worthwhile.